



Structured Administration & Supply Arrangement (SASA)

Chlorhexidine Wash 4%

Issuing Authority

Health Service	Sir Charles Gairdner Osborne Park Health Care Group
Address	Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, Western Australia
Contact	6457 2348

Authorisations

Practitioners:	SCGOPHCG Registered Nurse SCGOPHCG Medication Competent Enrolled Nurse
Practice Setting:	• Pre-admission Clinic (PAC) • Inpatient wards where surgery or procedure is applicable, this includes: ◦ G52, G53, G62, G63, G65, G66, G71, G73 and OPH Ward 6 • Haemodialysis Centre patients and Peritoneal Dialysis Inpatient and Outpatients • Day Therapy Unit Haematology and Oncology patients • Radiology department
Qualification:	Registered with the Nursing & Midwifery Board of Australia Enrolled Nurse who has completed a Board-approved qualification in administration of medicines
Authorisation:	Initiation, Administration, and Supply
Risk rating:	Low
Patients	Eligible patients as outlined in SCGOPHCG Mupirocin Nasal Ointment for Decolonisation

Approved Sites

Site	Site Address
1.	Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital, Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, WA
2.	Osbourne Park Hospital, Osbourne Place, Stirling, WA

Chlorhexidine Wash 4%

Route:	Topical	Brand:	Any stocked brand
Form:	Solution	Strength:	40mg/mL
Dose:	150-200mL (approx.)	Quantity:	2 x 500mL
Instructions:	Refer to: SCGOPHCG Mupirocin Nasal Ointment for Decolonisation Apply chlorhexidine 4% body wash ONCE daily for each of the FIVE days, <i>including</i> morning of the procedure. Where possible, aim to start 4 days prior to planned procedure.		
Administration Notes:	- Using a clean washcloth or your hands, apply approximately one third of the body wash to all areas, except your face. Make sure to apply to underarms, behind ears and knees, groin area and between skin folds including navel. Leave on your skin for 2 minutes, then rinse the wash off with water only. Dry thoroughly using a clean towel and wear clean garments afterwards. - Repeat each day for 5 days. - Shampoo your hair using the body wash on day 1, day 3 and day 5. Your normal conditioner can be used. - Take care not to get any in your eyes or mouth. - After showering with chlorhexidine, do not use any lotions, powders or creams on the skin.		
Patient Inclusion:	Patients undergoing a surgery or procedure admitted under: - Orthopaedic surgery (procedures involving implantation of prosthetic material) - Cardiothoracic surgery (all) - Neurosurgery (all) Patients for insertion of any of the following: - Non-tunnelled large bore central venous catheters (e.g. Vas-Cath™) - Tunnelled (subcutaneous) large bore central venous catheters (e.g. Hickman™) - Totally Implantable Venous Access Device (e.g. Infusaport™, Port-a-cath™, PAS-Port™) - Peritoneal Dialysis (PD catheter)		
Patient Exclusion:	Known or documented allergy to chlorhexidine or components of the formulation. Non high-risk surgical procedures/interventions outside the patient inclusion criteria of this SASA Patients undergoing routine insertion of short to medium term catheter insertions e.g. PICCs (peripherally inserted central catheter) or non-tunnelled, temporary CVCs		

Documentation:	Inpatients: • Nursing Admission Assessment MR852.2/MR132.2 additional Information section • WA Hospital Medication chart MR410/805 • Electronically via approved electronic software (i.e. MOSAIQ or hospital approved DMR) Outpatients: • Outpatients notes inclusive of MR 410 • Electronically via approved electronic software (i.e. MOSAIQ or hospital approved DMR) Pre-admission clinic: • Day Procedure Checklist MR710 • Nursing Admission Assessment MR852.2/MR132.2 additional Information section • Pre-Admission Clinic MR419
Adverse Effects:	Skin sensitivity, dryness
Clinical Guidelines	SCGOPHCG Mupirocin Nasal Ointment for Decolonisation SCGOPHCG Radiological Examination and Neuro Interventional Procedures

Related policies, procedures and guidelines

[SCGOPHCG Medicines Management](#)

[Infection Prevention and Control of Methicillin-resistant Staphylococcus aureus \(MRSA\) in Western Australian Healthcare Facilities](#)

[NPG Preoperative Care](#)

[SCGOPHCG Hip Fracture Management](#)

[Orthopaedic implant and cardiothoracic surgery Patient Pamphlet PAC](#)

References

1. Structured Administration and Supply Arrangements, Department of Health. Available at https://ww2.health.wa.gov.au/Articles/S_T/Structured-Administration-and-Supply-Arrangements

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Name	Michael Petrovski (SCGH) Melinda Leeder (OPH)	Endorsed	12/05/2025
Authorising Committee			
Committee	SCGOPHCG Medicines and Therapeutics Committee (MTC)		
Chairperson	Dr Deepan Krishnasivam	Endorsed	12/05/2025
Nursing			
Name	Annie Thompson	Signed:	
Position	Area Director of Nursing	Date:	16/06/2025
Senior Medical Practitioner			
Name	Dr Simon Wood	Signed:	
Position	A/Director of Clinical Services	Date:	16/06/2025
Executive			
Name	Dr Jodi Graham	Signed:	
Position	Executive Director	Date:	16/06/2025
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Owner:	Chief Pharmacist		
Standards	NSQHS Standards: 1 Governance  , 4 Medication Safety  ,		
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